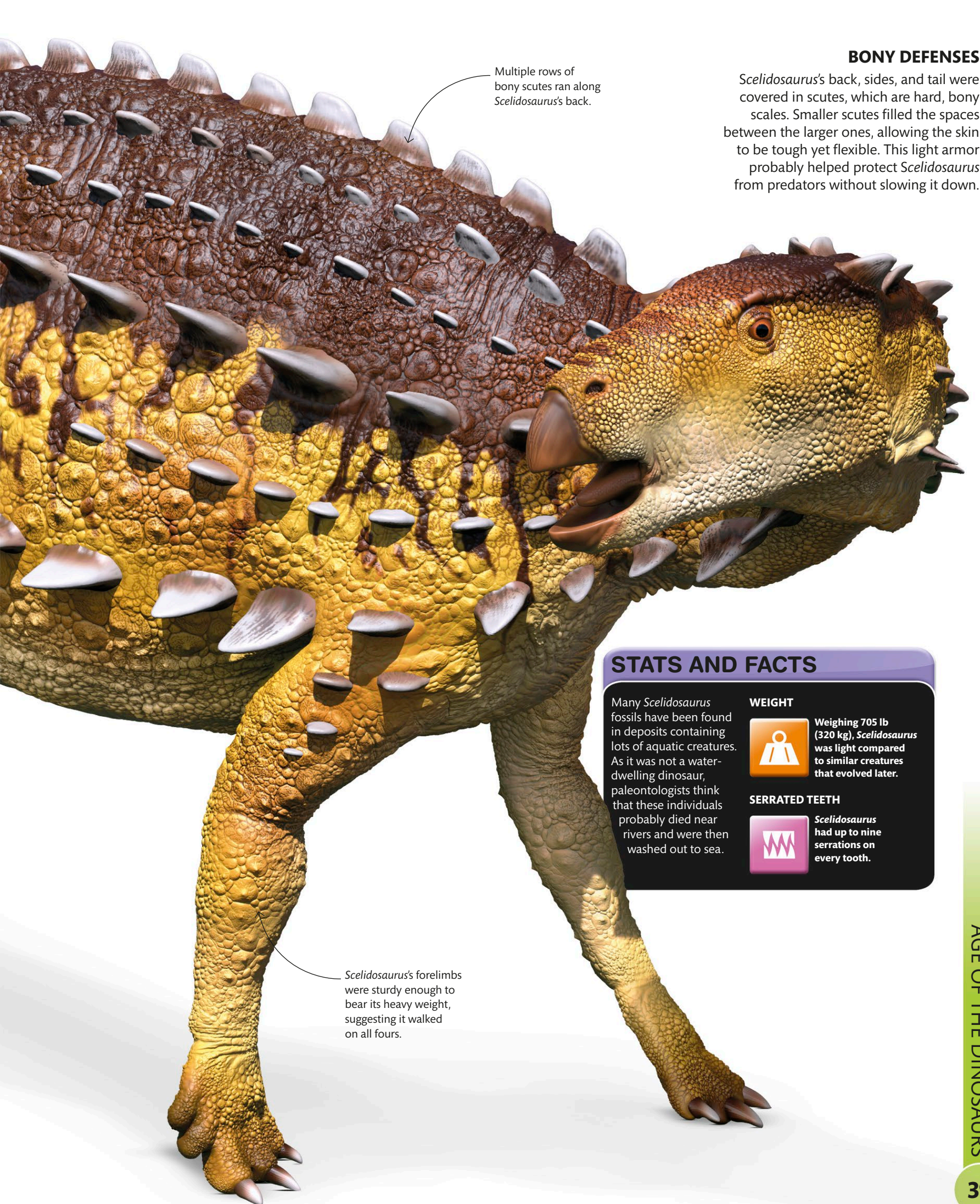




Multiple rows of bony scutes ran along *Scelidosaurus*'s back.

BONY DEFENSES

Scelidosaurus's back, sides, and tail were covered in scutes, which are hard, bony scales. Smaller scutes filled the spaces between the larger ones, allowing the skin to be tough yet flexible. This light armor probably helped protect *Scelidosaurus* from predators without slowing it down.

Scelidosaurus's forelimbs were sturdy enough to bear its heavy weight, suggesting it walked on all fours.

STATS AND FACTS

Many *Scelidosaurus* fossils have been found in deposits containing lots of aquatic creatures. As it was not a water-dwelling dinosaur, paleontologists think that these individuals probably died near rivers and were then washed out to sea.

WEIGHT



Weighing 705 lb (320 kg), *Scelidosaurus* was light compared to similar creatures that evolved later.

SERRATED TEETH



Scelidosaurus had up to nine serrations on every tooth.